OSTERVALE PROPERTY MANAGEMENT

Security Deposit Policy

Effective January 1, 2026 · Version 2026

This policy explains how security deposits and pet deposits are collected, held and returned at Larkfen Commons, managed by Ostervale Property Management. It is part of your Residential Lease Agreement.

1. Deposit Amounts

The standard security deposit at Larkfen Commons is $500 per apartment.

Applicants who are approved with conditions pay a security deposit equal to one full month's rent.

A refundable pet deposit is required for each registered pet, in the amount stated in the current Pet Policy. The pet deposit is separate from the security deposit.

The security deposit is due with your other move-in funds no later than 5:00 PM on the business day before your move-in date.

2. How Deposits Are Held

We hold all security deposits and pet deposits in a separate bank account that is used only for resident deposits.

Deposits are not used to pay operating expenses of the community while you live there.

3. What the Deposit Covers

The security deposit may be used to pay any amount you owe us when you move out.

This includes unpaid rent, late charges, utility charges, cleaning needed to return the apartment to its move-in condition, repair of damage beyond normal wear and tear, unreturned keys, fobs or hang tags, and other charges under your lease.

The pet deposit is applied first to pet-related damage and cleaning, and any remaining balance is applied to other charges.

The security deposit may not be used as payment of your last month's rent. Rent for your final month is due on the 1st as usual.

4. Normal Wear and Tear

You are not charged for normal wear and tear, which is the ordinary aging of the apartment from everyday living.

Small nail holes from hanging pictures, minor scuffs, sun-faded paint and carpet worn in walkways are considered normal wear and tear.

Large holes, burns, permanent carpet stains, broken blinds, pet damage and smoke odor are considered damage and are charged.

5. Move-In Condition Report

You must return your Move-In Condition Report within 5 calendar days after you pick up your keys.

At move-out, we compare the apartment with your Move-In Condition Report. Any item not noted on your report is considered to have been in good condition at move-in.

6. Pre-Move-Out Inspection

You may request an optional pre-move-out inspection during the 14 days before your move-out date.

During this inspection, a staff member points out items that may lead to deductions, so you have time to clean or correct them.

7. Final Move-Out Inspection

We inspect the apartment within 2 business days after all keys are returned.

You may attend the final inspection if you ask the leasing office at least 7 days before your move-out date.

The inspector takes dated photos of the apartment, which are kept with your deposit file.

8. Deposit Refund and Itemized Statement

We return your security deposit and pet deposit, less any deductions, within 30 days after you move out and return all keys.

Every refund comes with an itemized statement that lists each deduction, the reason for it and its amount.

The refund and statement are mailed to the forwarding address you give us in writing. If you do not give us a forwarding address, they are mailed to the apartment address.

The refund is issued as one check payable to all leaseholders, unless all leaseholders sign a written direction telling us how to divide it.

Typical cleaning and damage charges are listed in the Move-Out Checklist.

Sample Itemized Statement

The example below shows how a statement is laid out for a two-bedroom apartment with a $500 security deposit and one pet with a $400 pet deposit.

Line	Amount
Security deposit on file	$500.00
Pet deposit on file	$400.00
Carpet stain and odor treatment, one bedroom	minus $45.00
Oven and range not cleaned	minus $60.00
One unreturned mailbox key	minus $15.00
Refund mailed to forwarding address	$780.00

In this example, the pet deposit is applied first to the carpet treatment because the stains were caused by the pet.

9. Amounts Owed Beyond the Deposit

If the deductions are more than your deposits, you will receive a statement of the balance owed.

The remaining balance is due within 30 days of the itemized statement.

Balances that are not paid within 30 days may be referred to a collection agency.

10. Questions About Deductions

If you disagree with a deduction, contact resident billing in writing within 30 days of the itemized statement at billing@ostervale.example.

Include your forwarding address, your former apartment number, and any photos or receipts that support your request.

We will review your request and reply in writing within 10 business days.

11. Transfers Within Larkfen Commons

If you transfer to a different apartment at Larkfen Commons, your security deposit moves with you to the new apartment after your old apartment has been inspected.

Any charges for cleaning or damage in your old apartment are billed to your account, and the full deposit stays on file for the new apartment.

A unit transfer fee of $300 applies to every transfer.